which case Bodhidharma was probably born and raised in Kanchipuram.

By one account Bodhidharma went to China to establish Prajnatara's *Sarvastivada*, or 'theory of all existence', teaching there. By another it was because Buddhism was now under threat within India, so he migrated to ensure its continuance elsewhere. He is believed to have had an audience with the Chinese Emperor Wu of Liang in 527 CE, after which he settled in the Song mountains near Luoyang and the Shaolin monastery, where he meditated without speaking and with his face to the wall for nine years, and where he died no later than 554.

What Bodhidharma achieved in China is the stuff of legend, quite literally. That he followed the teachings of Nagarjuna is exemplified by his famous two-word answer of 'Vast emptiness' when asked by Emperor Wu to explain Buddhism. His and his chief disciples' rigorous promotion of the regulation of the mind through *dhyana*, which loosely translates as 'meditation', undoubtedly helped lay the foundations of Chan Buddhism, which evolved into Zen in Japan, where Bodhidharma is known as Daruma and is most often represented as a round, hollow wooden doll with blank staring eyes.